

ANAGHA ANEESH

PhD Student | Chemistry x AI

@aaneesh@stanford.edu

in LinkedIn

Github

Google Scholar

anagha-aneesh.com

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

PhD Student

Stanford University

Sept 2025 – Current

Researcher in **Prof. Grant Rotskoff's** group, training and evaluating LLMs for structural chemistry, reaction prediction, and synthesis planning. Built an end-to-end research codebase covering tokenization, SFT, RL post-training, and benchmarking, with Hydra-based configuration for full reproducibility.

Projects

- **Resonance** — RLVR (GRPO) on chemical reaction synthesis tasks, training small open-weight models for reaction prediction with a constitutional reward structure
- **MedChemAgent** — Building an autonomous medicinal chemistry agent using on-policy context distillation and downstream task-specific RL environments
- **Idiom** — Generative design of intrinsically disordered proteins; built sparse autoencoders and annotatable features to interpret the protein language model via mechanistic interpretability techniques
- **Terminal-Bench Science** — Designing uniquely challenging chemistry tasks for Terminal-Bench that reflect real computational chemistry and drug discovery workflows (in progress)

Fulbright Research Student

Friedrich Schiller University Jena

Sept 2024 – July 2025

- Full-time researcher in **Prof. Kevin Jablonka's** AI for chemistry and materials group
- Built an ML pipeline predicting device-level properties of perovskite solar cells from compositional and processing descriptors, handling leakage from chemically correlated features in multi-source experimental data

Undergraduate Research Student

Haverford College

May 2022 – May 2024

- In **Prof. Clyde Daly's** group, developed a predictive spectroscopic map for terminal alkyne vibrational probes combining DFT (QChem), ALMO-EDA, molecular dynamics, and ML regression; first-author manuscript published

Undergraduate Researcher (*Total Synthesis CURE*)

Haverford College

Sept 2022 – May 2023

- In **Prof. Grant Spoors'** group, redesigned the synthetic route to an endothelin antagonist with magnesium-mediated Grignard chemistry and a solvent change to acetonitrile that improved yield

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

AI Infrastructure Investing Intern

Andreessen Horowitz (a16z)

June 2026 – Sept 2026

- Working directly with **Lisha Li**, Partner in AI Infrastructure Investing, on market mapping and buyer validation across AI and life-sciences infrastructure

SUMMARY

First-year Chemistry PhD student at Stanford working at the intersection of **large language models and small-molecule chemistry**. Trained as both a synthetic and computational chemist, with hands-on experience training and evaluating LLMs for chemical reasoning, reaction prediction, and synthesis planning. Long-term goal: AI systems that can propose synthetic routes to **novel molecules** from scratch.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

LLM Training & Post-Training

HuggingFace Transformers, TRL, PEFT, vLLM, DeepSpeed ZeRO, GRPO, supervised fine-tuning, continued pre-training, lm-evaluation-harness

Cheminformatics & Computational Chemistry

RDKit, SMARTS / reaction SMARTS, Morgan fingerprints, DFT (QChem), ALMO-EDA, classical molecular dynamics, PubChem PUG REST

ML & Data

PyTorch, scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn

Infrastructure

SLURM, multi-node H100 / distributed training, Hydra, Weights & Biases, Bash, Git, Linux / HPC environments

Languages

Python (proficient), JavaScript / HTML / CSS (basic)

AWARDS

- NSF Graduate Research Fellowship, 2025
- Fulbright Germany Research Award, 2024
- ACS Undergraduate Physical Chemistry Award, 2024
- Liberal Arts in the Workplace Grant, Haverford College, 2022

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

- CS229: Introduction to Machine Learning, Stanford (Autumn 2025)

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

- **A. Aneesh**, N. Alampara, M. Ríos-García, *et al.*, “General-purpose models for the chemical sciences: Llms and beyond,” *Chemical Reviews*, vol. 126, no. 4, pp. 2484–2549, 2026, PMID: 41642594. DOI: 10.1021/acs.chemrev.5c00583. eprint: <https://doi.org/10.1021/acs.chemrev.5c00583>.
- K. Rossi, **A. Aneesh**, *et al.*, “2026 roadmap on digitalising materials science,” *Journal of Physics: Materials*, 2026, In final review; Section 5.2 lead author.
- **A. Aneesh**, K. Streu, and C. A. Daly Jr., “Development of a spectroscopic map to explain the broad raman peak for alkynes solvated in triethylamine,” *Journal of Physical Chemistry B*, 2025.
- A. Mirza, N. Alampara, S. Kunchapu, *et al.*, “A framework for evaluating the chemical knowledge and reasoning abilities of large language models against the expertise of chemists,” *Nature Chemistry*, vol. 17, pp. 1027–1034, 2025. DOI: 10.1038/s41557-025-01815-x.

Conference Proceedings

- **A. Aneesh**, N. Alampara, J. A. Márquez, and K. M. Jablonka, “Semantic device graphs for perovskite solar cell design,” in *International Conference on Learning Representations*, Published as a workshop paper at AI4MAT at ICLR 2025, ICLR, 2025.
- **A. Aneesh**, K. Streu, and C. A. Daly Jr., “Explaining terminal alkyne solvatochromism with flexible vibrational quantum mechanics,” in *American Chemical Society Fall Conference*, Accepted abstract and poster, ACS, 2023.

- CS109: Introduction to Algorithms and Data Structures, Haverford (Fall 2023)

EDUCATION

PhD | Chemistry

Stanford University

📅 Sept 2025 – Current

BS | Chemistry and Physics

Haverford College

📅 Sept 2020 – May 2024